

Section 1: Applicant Information

- **First & Last Name:** [You need to fill]
 - **Email:** ambika@ajaibghar.com
 - **Current location (city, country):** [Udaipur, India? or Netherlands? - you need to clarify]
 - **LinkedIn Profile URL** (*optional*)
 - **Professional website/portfolio URL** (*optional*)
 - **Years of relevant professional experience (choose one):**
 - 6-10 years
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Section 2: Eligibility Confirmation

- **Fellowship Availability:** are you available to begin a 12-month Fellowship in May 2026?
 - Yes
 - **Legal Eligibility:** can you legally receive grant payments from a US-based organization via ACH or wire transfer?
 - [You need to confirm]
 - **Were AI tools used to complete this application?**
 - Yes
 - **(If yes) How were AI tools used in completing this application?**
 - Grammar checking and to check if the answer is not too long winded and aligned to the application question.
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Section 3: Fellowship Track and Focus

- **Country of Residence:** [You need to fill]
- **Other countries with permission to work** (*optional*)
- **To which Fellowship track are you applying?**
 - Track II: Independent Fellow (Senior-level, independent project)

- **Primary Issue Area (select one):**
 - Building Open Infrastructure (or "Other")
 - **If other, please explain (50 characters)**
 - [Leave blank if you select "Building Open Infrastructure"]
 - **Why this focus area? What unique perspective or approach do you bring to this challenge? (400 characters)**
 - Solar-powered, community-learned language models challenge extractive AI infrastructure. With simple low energy and sustainable solutions and hands-on public pedagogy for non-technologists, especially women/non-binary creators in Global South, this project opens dialog for viable alternatives in the infrastructures of hardware and datasets.
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Section 4: Mission Alignment

- **Fellowship Motivation:** Mozilla Fellows are the kind of leaders a better technology future demands. How do you hope the Fellowship will advance your evolution as a tech leader? What do you hope to gain from this experience? (800 characters)

Through my research and pedagogy practices, I've built accessible spaces for women and non-binary creators to gain agency with technology. I've been fortunate that the work has been recognised at various platforms through talks, workshops and fellowships. But as a self-trained practitioner running independently, I lack peers for deep critical development and institutional validation that opens doors.

Mozilla Fellowship will provide me with: credible recognition for community-led alternatives to extractive tech; focussed year long time to research and grow the project; peer engagement on dataset ethics, feminist and decolonial AI methods. Most critically - it validates that care-centered public pedagogy is legitimate infrastructure work, not just 'outreach.'

- **Cohort Contribution:** What would you bring to a global cohort of technology leaders working toward better futures? How would you contribute to your fellow Fellows' growth and success? (500 characters)

I bring 7+ years facilitating feminist tech pedagogy - making AI/coding accessible to non-technologists through workshops (NYU Shanghai, Creative Coding Utrecht, Chaos Feminist Convention). I'm direct, warm, curious about people's work - quick to connect ideas across projects. My self-taught journey helps others feel comfortable with tech. I can facilitate hands-on AI sessions for Fellows and share methods for public pedagogy that centers care over expertise gatekeeping.

Section 5: Professional Background

- **Most Relevant Professional Experience:** highlight 2-3 examples of your work that best demonstrate you're ready for this Fellowship. Focus on projects where you had significant impact or leadership responsibility. *(1,200 characters)*

Coding with Friends (2020-2022): Coding with Friends was a series of live streams with womxn makers and creators. The series casually and simply claims space for womxn creators. This project received the Processing Foundation Fellowship in 2021.

code.drift & code.yatra (2023-ongoing): A locally rooted and small town focussed creative coding workshop series that focuses on creating new ways of seeing and drifting through contemporary Indian landscapes and simultaneously learning live (creative) coding. This project received the Godrej Design Lab Fellowship for an extension program called code.yatra which culminated in 100+ learners, and a specially developed board game to encourage people to learn creative coding. This project is part of Ajaibghar (a studio I co-run with Nanditi Khilnani)

Sun Shines Bright (2025-ongoing): Built solar-powered AI server prototype in Udaipur (200+ sunny days); facilitated workshops at NYU Shanghai, Creative Coding Utrecht; exhibited at AIXDESIGN Festival (Slow AI), Chaos Feminist Convention. Created accessible documentation for non-technologists. Trained 30+ participants in solar server setup and small language model concepts.

Community building: Co-founder Ajaibghar (feminist creative tech studio); featured speaker at Assembling Intelligence (HEAD Geneva), Pre-AI Summit India, Screenwalks Arnhem. Essay collaborations exploring AI/motherhood intersections.

Impact: Participants report increased confidence with tech; several started their own teaching practices; documentation accessed globally.

- **Technical Expertise:** what technical skills and experiences do you have that best equip you to carry out your proposed Fellowship project? *(400 characters)*

7+ years coding (p5.js, Python, web development, AI/ML) fine-tuning small language models with LoRA/MLX, dataset creation, RAG systems, Raspberry Pi deployment (all self-taught). Technical documentation for non-experts. Community tech: facilitating hands-on workshops where participants build working prototypes in 2-3 hours. Building and maintaining creative tech communities (online and offline).

- **Public Engagement & Communication:** please describe your experience sharing your work with broader audiences (e.g., writing, speaking, teaching). How do you make complex technical concepts accessible to diverse audiences? You can include links. *(600 characters)*

Speaking: [AI Impact Summit India Pre-Event Bengaluru \(2025\)](#), NYU Shanghai talks and workshop (2025), [Assembling Intelligence HEAD Geneva \(2024\)](#), [Museum of Contemporary Art Belgrade \(2024\)](#), [Jnanapravaha\(2024\)](#), Bump Festival (2023)

Writing: [Care with Computers. Essay with Diwas Raja Kc. Journal of Public Pedagogies. Number 7, 2023](#); Documentation at [solararchive.cmama.xyz](#); [Documentation for Goovey.AI](#) (as Head of Developer Relations).

I've trained over 200+ people on the basics of coding and AI. I also ran a very active livestream on Twitch.

Section 6: Project Proposal

- **Project Title** *(100 characters)*
 - Sun Shines Bright: Solar-Powered Community-Learned Language Models
- **Project Summary:** clearly outline the project you wish to undertake as part of your Mozilla Fellowship. What will you build or create? What challenge does it address? *(1,000 characters)*

[Sun Shines Bright](#) is a solar powered small language model server, that focuses on low-energy and sustainable methodologies for hosting Small Language Models and artist-led public pedagogy to collect and train own models that reflect the values and voices of creator communities.

Inspired by Solar Protocol, Sun Shines Bright reimagines our relationship with AI by demystifying and DIY-ing local and self-hosted AI servers, and cultivating community-led AI systems. Through practice and research, the project embodies the principles of care and camaraderie by:

- agency over the mainstream high-power black-boxed AI systems through hands-on tinkering with server setups
- a collaborative ecosystem where we can create “community learned language models” that include indigenous, non-white, feminist data that reflects our values and voices

The project asks: ***Can community-learned, solar-powered small language models create new forms of technological intimacy that resist extraction while fostering care?***

- **Vision Alignment:** how does your proposed project advance Mozilla Foundations's vision of technology that is "built with care, powered by people, fueled by imagination"? (600 characters)

My community-oriented capacity-building tech practice centers around care and community. While it is important to share and build prototypes, it is equally important to build inclusive spaces for creators to understand, make, and feel agency around what AI can mean to their practice. Tinkerability offers improved intimacy with closed, inaccessible and blackbox technology. It is necessary for explorative and creative practices to be situated in care to address the long-term impact of ecological and social impact of technology. That is how I see my work is aligned with Mozilla.

Sun Shines Bright isn't just about solar panels or language models, it's about building a critical relationship with new technology.

Sun Shines Bright embodies 'built with care, powered by people, fueled by imagination':

Built with care: Community-led dataset creation centers feminist, non-white voices systematically erased from AI. Workshops prioritize consent, attribution, slow learning over extraction.

Powered by people: Solar infrastructure makes computing costs visible—participants see energy consumption in real time. Community ownership vs. corporate cloud dependency. 25+ creators will own their models, not rent access.

Fueled by imagination: Reimagines AI as tinkerable, intimate technology vs. extractive black boxes. Proves 'SLM mamas' model—like Barefoot College solar engineers, participants become teachers who empower their networks.

- **Community-Centered Approach:** who are the communities most affected by the challenge or issue area your project is designed to address? How will you connect to, listen to, and learn from these communities? (600 characters)

This project is focused on bringing agency and accessibility to creators and researchers. Through committed partnerships with University of Amsterdam, AIXDesign, Ajaibghar, I will be able to connect with those interested in understanding the pervasive and black box nature of AI and those whose work organically intersects between AI, Datasets, Art, Gender, Community and Climate are the intended community of this project. New technologies reach minority audiences at the very end, and my practice is focused on unpacking it for those who might find it inaccessible as early as possible.

Affected communities: ~~Non-technologist creators (especially women/non-binary) locked out of AI dataset decision making; Global South communities whose languages/contexts are underrepresented in LLMs; artists/activists reliant on extractive corporate AI.~~

Connection methods:

- ~~• Co-design workshops (participants shape what gets built, not passive learners)~~
- ~~• Start with lived experience: 'Does AI serve YOUR language/context?'~~
- ~~• Partners bring existing trust networks (AIXDesign creators, Dr. Savic's students, Ajaibghar community)~~
- ~~• Accessible documentation (visual tutorials, Hindi/English)~~
- ~~• Follow-up support for home installations~~

~~Not extracting knowledge — building capacity to teach others.~~

- **Primary Project Outputs:** *select all that apply*
 - ✓ Technology platform or tool
 - ✓ Educational resources
 - ✓ Community organizing tools
 - ✓ Creative or artistic work
- **Success Metrics:** how will the impact of your proposed project be measured? Please include both quantitative and qualitative indicators in your response. (500 characters)

Quantitative: 2-3 functional solar servers (India/Netherlands); 30+ women/non-binary creators trained in model creation/hosting; 50-100 access online tutorials; 3-5 self-host at home, 4000+ views for project visibility via social media (Instagram followers are 4700+ and 10k+ views on Youtube)

Qualitative: Can we build and sustain community learned language models? Do created models reflect community values? Can we continue to have sustained experiments and conversations beyond the project?

- **Project Milestones:** please provide a high level quarterly timeline for your proposed Fellowship project, detailing key milestones and anticipated deliverables. Please note that all proposed project milestones and deliverables are subject to potential revision in consultation with Mozilla and/or Track I Host Organizations if you are selected for the Fellowship. (500 characters)

Q1 (May-Jul 2026): Solar server installations in India/Netherlands; fine-tuning experiments; develop accessible interfaces

Q2-Q3 (Aug-Dec 2026): Workshop series (decolonial/feminist AI context + hands-on building); 2-3 home installations with support; dataset creation with participants

Q4 (Jan-Feb 2027): Solar-hosted documentation launch; tutorial videos/guides; 4-6mo follow-up support for self-hosters; public presentation of community-created models

Section 7: Additional Information

- **How did you hear about this fellowship opportunity?** *Select one.*
 - [You need to answer - nominated or self-nominated?]
 - **Prior to your nomination, had you heard of Mozilla Fellowships?**
 - [You need to answer - Yes/No]
 - **If yes: how?** *Select one.*
 - [If applicable]
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What I still need from you:

1. Current location (city, country)
2. Can you legally receive US grant payments?
3. How did you hear about the fellowship?
4. Had you heard of Mozilla Fellowships before?